

# Welcome To The Vale

*The banners of war have long since fallen silent.*

*Across the Quiet Vale, roads once marched by armies now welcome traders, settlers, and wandering folk searching for somewhere safe to begin again.*

*You were once part of that older age: a scout, knight, scholar, healer, wanderer, or steward whose years of hardship now give way to rebuilding.*

*Across three changing Seasons, you will gather resources, expand a shared settlement, welcome new Arrivals, and overcome the Burdens left behind by a fractured world.*

*The Quiet Vale is not a game about conquest. It is a game about stewardship, resilience, and building a place that may endure.*

## How To Use This Playtest Guide

This is a trimmed table reference for learning the game. It keeps the core flow, costs, timing, and card handling rules players need during a playtest. The fuller production rulebook can keep the deeper wording and edge-case lists.

### USE CARD TEXT

When a card gives a specific exception, use the card. This guide explains the normal rules and avoids listing every card-specific fallback.

## Game Overview

The Quiet Vale is a cooperative tile-laying and settlement-building game for 1-4 players. The group builds a shared settlement across three Seasons, manages a shared Warehouse, reveals Encounters, welcomes Arrivals, and prevents Strain from disabling important tiles.

- Build and upgrade a shared settlement.
- Gather and spend shared resources from the Warehouse.
- Seed hidden Encounter Cards into the Encounter Deck.
- Complete Arrivals to unlock Special Tiles.
- Resolve or endure Burdens before Strain becomes too costly.

## Setup

1. Lay out the Game Map, Stewards Board, Warehouse Board, and Round Timer.
2. Each player chooses a unique Steward and takes that Steward's Player Aid and Steward House Tile.
3. Set the shared Warehouse using the player-count table.
4. Each player places their Steward's starting Resource Tile for free on matching terrain. This ignores normal placement costs and adjacency requirements.
5. Build the balanced Encounter pool, deal hidden player hands, build the Encounter Deck, and add 1 random Golden Boon.
6. Begin Round 1 with the Seed Encounter Cards phase.